

Spatial HW

Class

February 2026

3.34

a) Prove that $\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)]/\gamma(k\delta) \rightarrow 1$ as $\delta \downarrow 0$.

By definition,

$$\hat{\gamma}(k\delta) = \frac{1}{2(m-k)} \sum_{j=1}^{m-k} \{Z((j+k)\delta) - Z(j\delta)\}^2$$

so

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)] = \frac{1}{2(m-k)} \sum_{j=1}^{m-k} \mathbb{E}[\{Z((j+k)\delta) - Z(j\delta)\}^2].$$

By Definition,

$$\mathbb{E}[\{Z(t+h) - Z(t)\}^2] = 2\gamma(h)$$

so

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)] = \frac{1}{2(m-k)} \sum_{j=1}^{m-k} 2\gamma(k\delta) = \gamma(k\delta).$$

Therefore,

$$\frac{\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)]}{\gamma(k\delta)} = 1$$

. **QUESTION:** Why it requires small delta?(I guess it should be just $\hat{\gamma}$ instead of $\mathbb{E}\hat{\gamma}$)?

In that case are the terms independent ?

I don't think they're independent since some sum terms shares a common part. Although I don't really know the point of part (a) yet, maybe it's used in part dA Primer on Reproducing Kernel Hilbert Spaces

I am pretty sure that this part is only there to show that the estimator is asymptotically unbiased... if it's not that, then I have no clue

(b) Find $\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}(k\delta))$.

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)) = \frac{1}{4(m-k)^2} \text{Var} \left(\sum_{j=1}^{m-k} \Delta_j^2 \right),$$

where $\Delta_j = Z((j+k)\delta) - Z(j\delta)$. By $\text{Cov}(X^2, Y^2) = 2\text{Cov}(X, Y)^2$ we have

$$\text{Var}\left(\sum \Delta_j^2\right) = \sum_{i=1}^{m-k} \sum_{j=1}^{m-k} \text{Cov}(\Delta_i^2, \Delta_j^2) = \frac{1}{4(m-k)^2} \sum_{i=1}^{m-k} \sum_{j=1}^{m-k} 2[\text{Cov}(\Delta_i, \Delta_j)]^2.$$

Therefore,

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)) = \frac{1}{2(m-k)^2} \sum_{i,j=1}^{m-k} [\text{Cov}(Z((i+k)\delta) - Z(i\delta), Z((j+k)\delta) - Z(j\delta))]^2.$$

(c) Show that

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \text{cor}^2\{Z(\delta) - Z(0), Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta)\} = 0.$$

Let $\rho_j = \text{cor}\{Z(\delta) - Z(0), Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta)\}$ and recall that

$$\text{cor}\{X, Y\} = \frac{\text{Cov}(X, Y)}{\sqrt{\text{Var}(X)\text{Var}(Y)}}.$$

Observe that

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Cov}(Z(\delta) - Z(0), Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta)) &= \text{Cov}(Z(\delta), Z((j+1)\delta)) - \text{Cov}(Z(\delta), Z(j\delta)) \\ &\quad - \text{Cov}(Z(0), Z((j+1)\delta)) + \text{Cov}(Z(0), Z(j\delta)) \\ &= K(j\delta) - K((j-1)\delta) - K((j+1)\delta) + K(j\delta) \\ &= K(j\delta) - K(0) + K(0) - K((j-1)\delta) \\ &\quad + K(0) - K((j+1)\delta) + K(j\delta) - K(0) \\ &= -2\gamma(j\delta) + \gamma((j+1)\delta) + \gamma((j-1)\delta). \end{aligned}$$

This looks like second differences. For a Matern process with smoothness $0 < \kappa < 1$, we have

$$\gamma(t) = c_\kappa |t|^{2\kappa} + O(t^2)$$

If we multiply and divide by a small enough delta δ^2 we can get [someone verify the usage of \$\sim\$ here?](#) not sure what to use

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta^2 \frac{[\gamma((j+1)\delta) - \gamma(j\delta)] - [\gamma(j\delta) - \gamma((j-1)\delta)]}{\delta^2} \sim \delta^2 \gamma''(j\delta) = \delta^2 [c_\kappa (2\kappa)(2\kappa-1)(j\delta)^{2\kappa-2} + O(1)].$$

Moreover,

$$\text{Var}(Z(\delta) - Z(0)) = 2\gamma(\delta) = \text{Var}(Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta)).$$

Therefore for small δ , [can someone verify that I am using the \$\sim\$ properly here](#)

$$\rho_j \sim \frac{c_\kappa \delta^2 2\kappa(2\kappa-1)(j\delta)^{2\kappa-2} + O(\delta^2)}{2[c_\kappa \delta^{2\kappa} + O(\delta^2)]} = \frac{c_\kappa 2\kappa(2\kappa-1)(j\delta)^{2\kappa-2} + O(1)}{2[c_\kappa \delta^{2\kappa-2} + O(1)]} = C j^{4\kappa-4}.$$

So ρ_j^2 is asymptotically proportional to $j^{4\kappa-4}$, which means [are the sum limits below fine? i switched the first sum from \$T/\delta\$ to \$\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1\$ but don't know why there is a -1 in the sum anyway for this problem](#)

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta - 1 \rfloor} j^{4\kappa-4} = 0 \implies \lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \rho_j^2 = 0$$

We can then prove the result by splitting κ into cases.

For $0 < \kappa < 3/4$ we get a converging p series for the sum, so for some constant $C_2 > 0$,

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta - 1 \rfloor} j^{4\kappa-4} = \lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \cdot C_2 = 0.$$

For $\frac{3}{4} \leq \kappa < 1$, this makes $j^{4\kappa-4}$ monotone decreasing so we can bound it with an integral. For any decreasing func, we have

$$\int_1^{n+1} f(j) dj \leq \sum_{j=1}^n f(j) \leq f(1) + \int_1^n f(j) dj$$

so

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \left(\delta \int_1^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor} j^{4\kappa-4} dj \right) \leq \lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \left(\delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} j^{4\kappa-4} \right) \leq \lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \left(1 + \int_1^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} j^{4\kappa-4} dj \right).$$

If $\kappa = 3/4$, then the LHS becomes $\delta \ln(\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor)$ and RHS is $\delta (1 + \ln(\lfloor T/\delta - 1 \rfloor))$

which are both 0 in the limit.

If $3/4 < \kappa < 1$, then the LHS is $\delta \left(\frac{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor^{4\kappa-3}}{4\kappa-3} - \frac{1}{4\kappa-3} \right)$ and the RHS is $\delta \left(1 + \frac{(\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1)^{4\kappa-3}}{4\kappa-3} - \frac{1}{4\kappa-3} \right)$

which are both 0 in the limit.

Thus, for $0 < \kappa < 1$, we have $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \rho_j^2 = 0$.

(d) Prove $\hat{\gamma}(\delta)/\gamma(\delta) \rightarrow 1$ in L^2 .

Convergence in L^2 (mean square) requires

$$\mathbb{E} \left[\left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}(\delta)}{\gamma(\delta)} - 1 \right)^2 \right] \rightarrow 0.$$

Expanding this we get

$$\frac{1}{\gamma^2(\delta)} \left(\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}(\delta)) + (\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}(\delta)] - \gamma(\delta))^2 \right).$$

Based on the outcome of (a), it suffices to show $\frac{\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}(\delta))}{\gamma^2(\delta)} \rightarrow 0$ as $\delta \downarrow 0$. Recall that

$$\rho_j = \frac{\text{Cov}(Z(\delta) - Z(0), Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta))}{2\gamma(\delta)} = \frac{K(j\delta) - K((j-1)\delta) - K((j+1)\delta) + K(j\delta)}{2\gamma(\delta)}.$$

Observe that

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{cor}\{Z((i+1)\delta) - Z(i\delta), Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta)\} \\
&= \frac{K(|j-i|\delta) - K(|j-i-1|\delta) - K(|j-i+1|\delta) + K(|j-i|\delta)}{2\gamma(\delta)} \\
&= \rho_{|j-i|}.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore by part (b) and part (c),

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma})}{\gamma^2} &\propto \frac{1}{m^2} \sum_{i,j=1}^m \rho_{|i-j|}^2 = \frac{1}{m^2} [m\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-1} (m-l)\rho_l^2] \\
&= \frac{\rho_0}{m} + \frac{2}{m} \sum_{l=1}^{m-1} \frac{(m-l)}{m} \rho_l^2 \\
&\leq \frac{\rho_0}{m} + \frac{2}{m} \sum_{l=1}^{m-1} \rho_l^2 \rightarrow 0 \\
&\text{as } m \rightarrow \infty.
\end{aligned}$$

Since $\delta \propto \frac{1}{m}$, $\frac{\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma})}{\gamma^2} \rightarrow 0$ as $\delta \downarrow 0$ so $\hat{\gamma}(\delta)/\gamma(\delta) \rightarrow 1$ in L^2 so also in probability.

(e) Extend to $\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)/\gamma(k\delta) \rightarrow 1$.

Changing the k scales the arguments but does not change the power law exponent 2κ or the convergence rate of the approximation in Part (c). Thus, for any fixed integer k :

$$\frac{\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)}{\gamma(k\delta)} \xrightarrow{p} 1$$

(f) Prove $\hat{\kappa} \rightarrow \kappa$ as $\delta \downarrow 0$.

$$\hat{\kappa} = \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}(2\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}(\delta)}$$

From part (e), we can see the following as $\delta \downarrow 0$:

$$\frac{\hat{\gamma}(2\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}(\delta)} = \frac{\gamma(2\delta) \frac{\hat{\gamma}(2\delta)}{\gamma(2\delta)}}{\gamma(\delta) \frac{\hat{\gamma}(\delta)}{\gamma(\delta)}} \xrightarrow{p} \frac{\gamma(2\delta)}{\gamma(\delta)}$$

Since $\gamma(t) = c_\kappa |t|^{2\kappa} + O(t^2)$ for $0 < \kappa < 1$, we get

$$\frac{\gamma(2\delta)}{\gamma(\delta)} = \frac{c_\kappa |2\delta|^{2\kappa} + O(\delta^2)}{c_\kappa |\delta|^{2\kappa} + O(\delta^2)} = \frac{2^{2\kappa} \delta^{2\kappa} [1 + O(\delta^{2-2\kappa})]}{\delta^{2\kappa} [1 + O(\delta^{2-2\kappa})]} \rightarrow 2^{2\kappa}$$

as $\delta \downarrow 0$. Apply the continuous function for $x > 0$, $g(x) = \frac{1}{2} \log_2(x)$, and this yields

$$\hat{\kappa} = g\left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}(2\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}(\delta)}\right) \xrightarrow{p} \frac{1}{2} \log_2(2^{2\kappa}) = \frac{1}{2}(2\kappa) = \kappa.$$

3.35

(a) Find $\kappa \in (0, 1)$ for which $\sum_{j=1}^{\infty} \text{corr}^2\{Z(\delta) - Z(0), Z((j+1)\delta) - Z(j\delta)\}$ is finite.

As discussed in 3.34 (c) to show that $\sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \rho_j^2 < \infty$ as $\delta \downarrow 0$ it suffices to show that

$$\lim_{\delta \rightarrow 0} \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} j^{4\kappa - 4} < \infty.$$

This is a p -series so the convergence condition is given by

$$4 - 4\kappa > 1 \iff 3 > 4\kappa \iff \kappa < \frac{3}{4}.$$

Thus the sum is finite for $0 < \kappa < 0.75$.

(b) In the finite case, show $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)}{\gamma(k\delta)} \right) \sim \beta\delta$.

please someone check the constants here. The general proportionality I think is right but constants giving the equalities may be wrong. Why do we need the β' part? Can't we just have β ? also the constants look good

Recall

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}}{\gamma} \right) &= \frac{2}{(m-k)^2} \sum_{i,j=1}^{m-k} \rho_{|i-j|}^2 \\ &= \frac{2}{(m-k)^2} [(m-k)\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} (m-k-l)\rho_l^2] \\ &= \frac{2}{(m-k)} [\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} \frac{(m-k-l)}{m-k} \rho_l^2]. \end{aligned}$$

We know $[\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} \frac{(m-k-l)}{m-k} \rho_l^2] \leq \rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} \rho_l^2 \rightarrow \beta$ for some constant β as $m \rightarrow \infty$ because we are in the finite case $0 < \kappa < 0.75$. Therefore for small k relative to m , $m \text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}}{\gamma} \right) \rightarrow \beta'$ for some constant β' . Since $\delta \propto \frac{2}{m-k}$, $\text{Var}(\frac{\hat{\gamma}}{\gamma}) \sim \beta'\delta$.

(c) In the infinite case, show $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)}{\gamma(k\delta)} \right) \rightarrow \infty$, and find a relatively simple asymptotic expression.

From (b) we know

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}}{\gamma} \right) &= \frac{2}{(m-k)} [\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} \frac{(m-k-l)}{m-k} \rho_l^2] \\
&\geq \frac{1}{(m-k)} \sum_{l=1}^{\lfloor \frac{m-k-1}{2} \rfloor} \frac{(m-k-l)}{m-k} \rho_l^2 \\
&\geq \frac{1}{(m-k)} \sum_{l=1}^{\lfloor \frac{m-k-1}{2} \rfloor} \frac{(m-k)}{2(m-k)} \rho_l^2 \\
&\geq \frac{1}{2(m-k)} \sum_{l=1}^{\lfloor \frac{m-k-1}{2} \rfloor} \rho_l^2.
\end{aligned}$$

If the sum is not finite as $m \rightarrow \infty$ then $\text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}}{\gamma} \right)$ blows up as $\delta \downarrow 0$. We can continue the lower bound by treating the sum as an upper bound on an integral. Recall that from 34(c), $\rho_j \sim Cj^{2\kappa-2}$ for small δ . **someone make precise this approximation step please someone verify this, putting in blue for now:** Thus $\lim_{j \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\rho_j^2}{j^{4\kappa-4}} = 1$, so for all $\epsilon > 0$, there exists N such that for all $j \geq N$, $\rho_j^2 \geq (1-\epsilon)j^{4\kappa-4}$. Thus,

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{1}{2(m-k)} \sum_{l=1}^{\lfloor \frac{m-k-1}{2} \rfloor} \rho_l^2 &\approx \frac{1}{2(m-k)} \sum_{l=1}^{\lfloor \frac{m-k-1}{2} \rfloor} l^{4\kappa-4} \\
&\geq \frac{1}{2(m-k)} \int_1^{\lfloor \frac{m-k-1}{2} \rfloor + 1} j^{4\kappa-4} dj
\end{aligned}$$

If $\kappa = 3/4$ then this lower bound is proportional to $\delta \ln(\frac{1}{\delta})$. If $3/4 < \kappa < 1$, then this lower bound is proportional to $\delta^{4-4\kappa}$. We can also derive upper bounds.

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Var} \left(\frac{\hat{\gamma}}{\gamma} \right) &= \frac{2}{(m-k)} [\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} \frac{(m-k-l)}{m-k} \rho_l^2] \\
&\leq \frac{2}{(m-k)} [\rho_0 + 2 \sum_{l=1}^{m-k-1} \rho_l^2] \\
&\leq \frac{2}{(m-k)} [\rho_0 + 2(1 + \int_1^{\lfloor m-k-1 \rfloor - 1} \rho_l^2)] \\
&\approx \frac{2}{(m-k)} [\rho_0 + 2(1 + \int_1^{\lfloor m-k-1 \rfloor - 1} l^{4\kappa-4})].
\end{aligned}$$

If $\kappa = 3/4$ then this upper bound is proportional to $\delta \ln(\frac{1}{\delta})$. If $3/4 < \kappa < 1$ then this upper bound is proportional to $\delta^{4-4\kappa}$. **I am a little skeptical that the both the upper bound and lower bound have been precisely characterized because**

it is generally more difficult to establish both. If someone can check carefully and look for a mistake that would be great...I'm not sure you can replace the sum with the integral in this upperbound, since ρ_l^2 is not necessarily monotone? Therefore the variance asymptotically decays at a rate $\delta \ln(\frac{1}{\delta})$ for $\kappa = 0.75$ and at a rate $\delta^{4-4\kappa}$ for $1 > \kappa > 0.75$.

(d)

3.36

Suggested indirectly to add more terms to the Taylor series approx. to think about it

Look into approx $f_n \sim C * g$ where g is a simple function like n^α

$\text{Var}(\frac{\hat{\gamma}(k\delta)}{\gamma(k\delta)}) \sim \frac{c}{m}$ look for a formula for this that doesn't depend on m

Look into a some sort of integral for an approx.

question: Why underestimation Semivariogram of FBM Its is likely due to the bias that exists if we get stuck act as if $-c_1|t|^{2\nu}$ is covariance func (generalized cov. fun

Approach: Look into intervals of $[N, N+1)$ to notice if certain patterns are generalizable. Patterns to look into

- N-th order differencing
- Variogram estimator

Case 1: $1 \leq \kappa \leq 2$ We will redefine $\hat{\gamma}(\cdot)$ to be

$$\hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta) := \frac{1}{2(m-2k)} \sum_{j=1}^{m-2k} \{Z((j+2k)\delta) - 2Z((j+k)\delta) + Z(j\delta)\}$$

Let $Y_{j,k} := Z((j+2k)\delta) - 2Z((j+k)\delta) + Z(j\delta)$

Then $\hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta) = \frac{1}{2M} \sum_{j=1}^M (Y_{j,k})^2$ where $M = m - 2k \approx T/\delta$

$$\gamma_2(k\delta) = \frac{1}{2} \mathbb{E}[Y_{j,k}^2]$$

$$\begin{aligned} E[Y_{j,k}^2] &= \text{Var}(Y_{j,k}) \\ &= \text{Var}(Z((j+2k)\delta) - 2Z((j+k)\delta) + Z(j\delta)) \end{aligned}$$

By $K(h) = \text{Cov}(Z(0), Z(h))$ we have

$$\text{Var}(Y_{j,k}) = 6K(0) - 8K(k\delta) + 2K(2k\delta)$$

Since $K(h) = K(0) - \gamma(h)$, we have

$$\text{Var}(Y_{j,k}) = -2\gamma(2k\delta) + 8\gamma(k\delta)$$

Then define the second order variogram as
34(b)

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta)) = \frac{1}{4M^2} \sum_{i=1}^M \sum_{j=1}^M \text{Cov}(Y_{i,k}^2, Y_{j,k}^2) = \frac{1}{2M^2} \sum_{i=1}^M \sum_{j=1}^M \text{Cov}(Y_{i,k}, Y_{j,k})^2$$

Let $\rho^{(2)}(i-j) = \text{cor}(Y_{i,k}, Y_{j,k})$. Then

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta)) = \frac{1}{2M^2} \sum_{i=1}^M \sum_{j=1}^M 2\gamma_2(k\delta)^2 \rho^{(2)}(i-j)^2 = \frac{\gamma_2(k\delta)^2}{M^2} \sum_{i=1}^M \sum_{j=1}^M \rho^{(2)}(i-j)^2$$

34(c) Show that

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \text{cor}^2(Y_{0,k}, Y_{j,k}) = 0$$

Note that this is equivalent to showing that $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \rho^{(2)}(j)^2 = 0$.

Note that

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Cov}(Y_{0,k}, Y_{j,k}) &= \text{Cov}(Z(2k\delta) - 2Z(k\delta) + Z(0), Z((j+2k)\delta) - 2Z((j+k)\delta) + Z(j\delta)) \\ &= K((j+2k)\delta) - 4K((j+k)\delta) + 6K(j\delta) - 4K((j-k)\delta) + K((j-2k)\delta) + 4K(k\delta) - 2K(0) \end{aligned}$$

Since $K(h) = K(0) - \gamma(h)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Cov}(Y_{0,k}, Y_{j,k}) &= -\gamma((j+2k)\delta) + 4\gamma((j+k)\delta) - 6\gamma(j\delta) + 4\gamma((j-k)\delta) - \gamma((j-2k)\delta) \\ &= -\gamma((j+2k)\delta) + 4\gamma((j+k)\delta) - 6\gamma(j\delta) + 4\gamma((j-k)\delta) - \gamma((j-2k)\delta) \end{aligned}$$

This looks like a fourth order difference. For a Matern process with smoothness $1 < \kappa < 2$,

$$\text{Cov}(Y_{0,k}, Y_{j,k}) \sim \delta^4 K^{(4)}(j\delta) = \delta^4 c_\kappa (j\delta)^{2\kappa-4}$$

Therefore, $\rho^{(2)}(j) \sim C \frac{\delta^4 (j\delta)^{2\kappa-4}}{\delta^{2\kappa}} \propto j^{2\kappa-4}$ for some constant C

Now we can reframe the problem as showing that $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} j^{4\kappa-8} = 0$. This is a p -series so the convergence condition.

We can see that for $1 < \kappa < 7/4$, $4\kappa - 8 < -1$ so the sum term converges to a constant as $\delta \downarrow 0$ and thus the limit is 0. For $7/4 \leq \kappa < 2$, a similar argument as in 3.34(c) can be used to show that the limit is also 0. Therefore, for $1 < \kappa < 2$, $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \text{cor}^2(Y_{0,k}, Y_{j,k}) = 0$.

34(d) Similar argument to prior as

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\gamma}_2(2k\delta) &= \gamma_2(2k\delta)(1 + o_p(1)) \\ \hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta) &= \gamma_2(k\delta)(1 + o_p(1)) \end{aligned}$$

For small δ , using the approximation $\gamma(t) = c_\kappa |t|^{2\kappa}$

$$\frac{\hat{\gamma}_2(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta)} \approx \frac{c(2\delta)^{2\kappa}}{c(\delta)^{2\kappa}} \approx 2^{2\kappa}$$

Therefore, $\hat{\kappa} = \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}_2(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_2(k\delta)} \xrightarrow{P} \kappa$.

Case 2: $N < \kappa < N + 1$ for some integer $N \geq 2$

We can define the N -th order difference as

$$Y_{j,k}^{(N)} := \sum_{l=0}^N (-1)^l \binom{N}{l} Z((j + lk)\delta)$$

Then we can define the N -th order variogram as

$$\gamma_N(k\delta) = \frac{1}{2} \mathbb{E}[(Y_{j,k}^{(N)})^2]$$

Define $M_N = m - Nk$.

Then we can define the estimator for the N -th order variogram as

$$\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta) := \frac{1}{2M_N} \sum_{j=1}^{M_N} (Y_{j,k}^{(N)})^2$$

34(a)

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)] = \frac{1}{2M_N} \sum_{j=1}^{M_N} \mathbb{E}[Y_{j,k}^M] = \frac{1}{2} \text{Var} Y_{j,k}^M$$

Define the N -th order variogram as

$$\gamma_N(k\delta) = \frac{1}{2} \text{Var} Y_{j,k}^M$$

Then we can show that $\mathbb{E}[\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)] = \gamma_N(k\delta)$ so $\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)$ is an unbiased estimator for $\gamma_N(k\delta)$.

34(b)

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)) = \frac{1}{4M_N^2} \sum_{i=1}^{M_N} \sum_{j=1}^{M_N} \text{Cov}((Y_{i,k}^{(N)})^2, (Y_{j,k}^{(N)})^2) = \frac{1}{2M_N^2} \sum_{i=1}^{M_N} \sum_{j=1}^{M_N} \text{Cov}(Y_{i,k}^{(N)}, Y_{j,k}^{(N)})^2$$

Define $\rho^{(N)}(i - j) = \text{cor}(Y_{i,k}^{(N)}, Y_{j,k}^{(N)})$. Then

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)) = \frac{\gamma_N(k\delta)^2}{M_N^2} \sum_{i=1}^{M_N} \sum_{j=1}^{M_N} \rho^{(N)}(i - j)^2$$

34(c) We notice that

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \text{cor}^2(Y_{0,k}^{(N)}, Y_{j,k}^{(N)}) = \sum_{a=0}^N \sum_{b=0}^N (-1)^{M-a+N-b} \binom{N}{a} \binom{N}{b} K((l+b-a)k\delta)$$

This would be a $2N$ -th order difference.

For a Taylor expansion of $K(h)$ around $h = 0$, the first non-zero term would be the $2N$ -th order term because the first $2N - 1$ order terms would be 0 due to the definition of the N -th order difference. Therefore, we can approximate this as

$$\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \text{cor}^2(Y_{0,k}^{(N)}, Y_{j,k}^{(N)}) \sim \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} C j^{4\kappa - 4N}$$

This is a p -series so the convergence condition is given by

$$4N - 4\kappa > 1 \iff N - \frac{1}{4} > \kappa$$

Thus, the sum is finite for $N < \kappa < N + 1$ where $N - \frac{1}{4} > \kappa$. And for $N < \kappa < N + 1$ where $N - \frac{1}{4} \leq \kappa$, the sum is infinite and we can use a similar argument as in 34(c) to show that $\lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \delta \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor T/\delta \rfloor - 1} \text{cor}^2(Y_{0,k}^{(N)}, Y_{j,k}^{(N)}) = 0$.

34(d)

We can use a similar argument as in 34(d) to show that $\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)/\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta) \xrightarrow{p} 2^{2\kappa}$ and thus $\hat{\kappa} = \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)} \xrightarrow{p} \kappa$.

34(e)

For any $k \geq 1$, we can use a similar argument as in 34(d) to show that $\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)/\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta) \xrightarrow{p} 2^{2\kappa}$ and thus $\hat{\kappa} = \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)} \xrightarrow{p} \kappa$.

34(f)

Define $\hat{\kappa}_N := \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)}$.

Since $\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta) \approx C_M(2\delta)^{2\kappa}$ and $\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta) \approx C_M(\delta)^{2\kappa}$, we can see that

$$\frac{\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)} \approx 2^{2\kappa}$$

Therefore, $\hat{\kappa}_N = \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)} \xrightarrow{p} \kappa$.

35(a) Note that for any interval $[N, N+1)$ where N is an integer, the "critical threshold" for κ is given by $N - \frac{1}{4}$.

For any $k \geq 1$, we can use a similar argument as in 34(d) to show that $\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)/\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta) \xrightarrow{p} 2^{2\kappa}$ and thus $\hat{\kappa} = \frac{1}{2} \log_2 \frac{\hat{\gamma}_N(2k\delta)}{\hat{\gamma}_N(k\delta)} \xrightarrow{p} \kappa$.